

Jonathan Palisoc

(916) 802-9825 · jpalisoc@umich.edu · jonpalisoc.com

sph.umich.edu/hmp/phdstudents/palisoc-jonathan.html

Dept. of Health Management & Policy · University of Michigan · Ann Arbor, MI 48109

EDUCATION

University of Michigan
Ph.D. Candidate, Health Services Organization & Policy (Economics Cognate) Ann Arbor, MI
exp. 2026

Research Interests: Medicaid and Medicare policy, health care financing, managed care, uncompensated and charity care, high-need populations, payment and delivery reform, medical debt

Dissertation: “Administrative Architecture and Medicaid: Essays on Barriers, Burdens, and Bargaining”

University of California, Berkeley
Master of Public Policy (M.P.P.) Berkeley, CA
2018

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo
Bachelor of Science, Quantitative Economics San Luis Obispo, CA
2013

SELECTED GRANTS, HONORS, & AWARDS

Rackham Merit Fellow, University of Michigan	2021–2026
Winner, NAELA Foundation Medicaid Estate Recovery Research Competition	2025
HSR Student Fellow, Institute for Healthcare Policy & Innovation	2023–2024
Finalist, Michigan Health Policy Case Competition	2022
Junior Service Fellow, Agency for Healthcare Research & Quality	2022
Distinguished Service Award, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services	2020
Young Leader Immersion Awardee, Filipino Young Leaders Program (FYLPRO)	2019
Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor (GSI) Award, UC Berkeley	2017, 2018
Superior Success Award, California Legislature for Assembly Bill 85 (2013)	2015
DHCS Academy Leader Award, California Department of Healthcare Services	2014
Dean’s List, California Polytechnic State University San Luis Obispo	2011–2013
Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America	2009

RESEARCH & POLICY PUBLICATIONS

Publications in peer-reviewed journals

Mueller, L., Palisoc, J., Batlivala, N. et al. [A Novel Intervention for Medicaid Beneficiaries with Complex Needs](#). Journal of General Internal Medicine (2025).

Manuscripts in review or prepared for submission

Hoffman GJ, Palisoc J. “Medicare’s Rural Floor Wage Index Adjustment: Implications for Health Equity.” Under review.

Tipirneni R, Palisoc J. “The Affordable Care Act’s Role in Aging Disparities Before and After Medicare Eligibility.” Under review.

Palisoc J. “Removing the Gate: Medicaid Prior Authorization For Buprenorphine And Prescribing.” Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. “Electronic Visit Verification and Medicaid Home Care Spending, Utilization, and Provider Participation: Evidence From a Staggered Federal Mandate.” Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. “Coverage Changes After California’s 2024 Medi-Cal Adult Expansion.” Prepared for submission to Health Affairs Scholar.

Working papers

Palisoc J. Fear as a Barrier to Coverage — Public Charge Chilling Effects. Dissertation Paper 1 (Job Market Paper).

Palisoc J. Suspension vs. Termination — Medicaid Continuity & Reentry Outcomes. Dissertation Paper 2.

Palisoc J. Pooling Is Not Enough — Medicaid Drug Purchasing Pools, Pharmacy-Benefit Governance, and Supplemental Rebate Capture. Dissertation Paper 3. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. Medicaid Expansion, First-Year Coverage Gains, and a Bounded Mortality Null After Prison Release. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. The Fertility Option — Postpartum Extension, LARC Uptake & Interpregnancy Intervals.

Palisoc J. The Procedural Wedge: Cross-Sectional Evidence on Medicaid Disenrollment and Community Health Center Finances During the Unwinding, with a Null-First-Stage Methodological Note. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research (Research Brief).

Palisoc J. Federally Qualified Health Centers and County Uninsurance: An Association Analysis with Proper Shift-Share Inference. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research (Methods Article).

Palisoc J. At 250 Percent of Poverty — Hospital Discounted Care, Patient Liability, and Collections in Colorado.

Palisoc J. Coverage Continues, Benefits Shrink — The Age-21 EPSDT Cliff for Former Foster Youth.

Palisoc J. Aging Out at 26 — The Consequences of Losing Mandatory Medicaid Coverage for Former Foster Youth.

Palisoc J. Effects of Medicaid Managed Care Competition on Quality, Spending, and Outcomes.

Palisoc J. The 1972 §1902(f) Wedge — A 50-Year Border-Pair Look at Medicaid Coverage, SSI Uptake, and Mortality in Eleven “209(b)” States. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. The Medicaid IMD Exclusion and the Decline of State Mental Hospitals — A Within-State Pre-Trend Test on Newly Digitized NIMH Census Data.

Palisoc J. Section 1108's Long Shadow — Sixty Years of Capped Medicaid in the U.S. Territories, 1968–2024.

Palisoc J. Who Responds When Children's Medicaid Becomes Continuous? Heterogeneity by Parental Education in the Labor-Supply Response to Multi-Year §1115 Continuous-Eligibility Waivers.

Palisoc J. State Medicaid Coverage Decisions and GLP-1 Utilization for Obesity: Causal Evidence from 17 States, 2022–2025. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. Fixed-Effect Sensitivity in FMAP-Kink Regression Designs: A Public-Data Methods Note on Medicaid LTSS Spending at the 50% Statutory Floor. Prepared for submission to Medical Care.

Palisoc J. Heterogeneous Compliance with the FTC Express Scripts Consent Order: Evidence from the First Post-Settlement Insulin Formulary. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs Scholar.

Palisoc J. Bans Without Bite: State Spread-Pricing Laws and Medicaid Generic Drug Spending. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. Setup Leaves Public Traces: A Public-Data Linkage Playbook for Medicaid Program Integrity. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs Scholar.

Palisoc J. When the Office Closes: SSA Field Office Closures, the SSI-Medicaid Linkage, and Medicaid Coverage Among Disabled Adults. Prepared for submission to American Economic Journal: Applied Economics.

Palisoc J. Medical Debt Complaints in the US: An Analysis of The CFPB's Consumer Complaints Database.

Palisoc J. The Effect of Medicaid Reimbursement Rates on Provider Participation and Access: A Systematic Review.

Palisoc J. The Affordable Care Act's Differential Effects on Health Coverage for the Asian American, Native Hawaiian, Pacific Islander, and American Indian Populations.

Palisoc J, Becker NV. Medical Debt Complaints in the US: An Analysis of The CFPB's Consumer Complaints Database.

Chopra Z, Palisoc J, Parolin E, Perry M, Hoffman G. Medicaid Estate Recovery: Evidence on Cost Effectiveness and Administration.

Palisoc J. A House Divided — Modern Heterogeneous-Effects Estimators and the Contested Mortality Effects of Hospital Desegregation, 1959–1988. Prepared for submission to Review of Economics and Statistics.

Palisoc J. Forty Years of Rebalancing — Target-Population-Specific 1915(c) Waivers and the Slow Death of the ICF/MR, 1981–2010.

Palisoc J. Paperwork, Proof, and Pediatric Coverage — The 2006 Citizenship Documentation Rule as an Administrative Friction Shock.

Palisoc J. State Nursing-Home Staffing Floors and the Distributional Bite — Heterogeneity by Medicaid Share and Rurality. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. State-Directed Payments in Medicaid Managed Care: A Pre-OBBA Pooled Null on Hospital Financial Effects. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. Procedural-Disenrollment Pauses and Medicaid Renewal Outcomes During the 2023 Unwinding. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. Coverage Effects of Oregon's All-Ages Medicaid Expansion: Synthetic-Control Evidence with OHP Bridge Disclosure. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs Scholar.

Palisoc J. Putting Teeth Into Medicaid: State Adult Dental Benefit Expansions and Population-Level Utilization — An Honest-Null Short-Panel Difference-in-Differences Analysis of BRFSS, 2016–2023. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. State Medicaid Doula Coverage and Birth Outcomes: A Staggered Difference-in-Differences Analysis, 2019–2024. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. Trading Inpatient Beds for Uncertain Margins — Rural Emergency Hospital Conversions, Inpatient Capacity, and Hospital Finances. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research.

Palisoc J. When Work Requirements Met the States — Two Case Studies of Section 1115 Medicaid Community Engagement Mandates in Arkansas and Georgia. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. Re-examining the OBRA Medicaid Pregnancy Expansions: An Honest-Null Replication Using the Currie–Gruber Simulated-Bite Design. Prepared for submission to Health Services Research (Research Brief).

Palisoc J. Health Insurance for the Undocumented — State Medicaid for Non-Citizens. Prepared for submission to Health Affairs.

Palisoc J. Coverage Before Release — Medicaid Reentry Waivers and Pre-Release §1115 Authorities.

Palisoc J. Did Losing Medicaid Make Anyone Sicker? A Composition / Null Reading of the Post-Pandemic Unwinding in BRFSS and ACS.

Palisoc J. California's County Health Care Backstop — Section 17000 After AB 85. Prepared for the Health Affairs 2026 California issue.

Palisoc J. Pricing the Golden Years — A Regression-Discontinuity Analysis of Age-Based Adoption Fee Waivers on Shelter Animal Outcomes. Prepared for submission to Animals (MDPI).

Acknowledgments in peer-reviewed publications

Jacobs PD, Hill SC, Monnet JN. “Newly and Previously Eligible Medicaid Enrollees Differ, but Not in Health Care Expenditures.” J Health Care Poor Underserved. 1 Aug 24. doi: 10.1353/hpu.2024.a934299

Blog posts, policy briefs, and presentations in other media

Palisoc J. Medicaid Eligibility and Enrollment Bonanza; A Crash Course in Medicaid Financing. Out-of-Pocket Retreat. 2023, 2024.

Palisoc J. [With ACA Subsidy Stoppage, What's Next for California Healthcare?](#) Berkeley Public Policy Journal. Published October 19, 2017.

Palisoc J, Chen L. [Obamacare Repeal Almost Certain, But Questions Remain.](#) Berkeley Public Policy Journal. Published January 20, 2017.

PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

Paper Presentation: “Effects of Medicaid Interstate Drug Purchasing Pools on Supplemental Rebate Capture.” ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2026.

Paper Presentation: “Effects of Medicaid Managed Care Competition on Quality, Spending, and Outcomes.” Cato Health Policy Workshop, 2025.

Paper Presentation: “Fear as a Barrier to Coverage — Public Charge Chilling Effects.” APPAM Annual Conference, 2025.

Paper Presentation: “Fear as a Barrier to Coverage — Public Charge Chilling Effects.” ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2025.

Discussant: “Mortality and Immigration Enforcement: The Case of Secure Communities.” ASHEcon Annual Conference, 2025.

Panel Chair: “Experimenting with Medicaid: Updates from Recent Section 1115 Waivers.” AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, 2024.

Discussant: “Characteristics of Patients, Providers, and Managed Care Organizations Participating in Four Medicaid Value-Based Payment Programs.” Lewis AJ. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting, 2024.

Panel Chair: “Achieving Payer-FQHC Partnership Success in the Value-Based Environment.” Yuvo Health, 2022.

SERVICE AND AFFILIATIONS

Abstract Reviewer, AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting — Medicaid, Coverage & Access 2022–2025

Abstract Reviewer, ASHEcon Annual Conference 2023–2025

Ad-hoc Peer Reviewer, Medical Care Review 2025–2026

Director & Executive Board Member, Society of Health Policy Young Professionals 2019–2022

Medical Debt and Charity Care Negotiation Volunteer, DollarFor

Inaugural Member, Out-of-Pocket Society

President, UC Berkeley Health Policy Club 2016–2018

Manuscript Reviewer, Michigan Undergraduate Journal of Public Health 2022–2024

Staff Writer, Berkeley Public Policy Journal 2016–2018

Member, American Society of Health Economists; AcademyHealth; Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Oakland University, School of Public Health Lecturer — PH 5700: Health Management and Policy	Rochester, MI 2023–2026
Medicaid, Actually Creator & Instructor — Original Medicaid policy, financing, and operations course	Remote 2025–Present
University of Michigan, Ross School of Business Teaching Assistant — BE 708: Health Care Markets & Public Policy	Ann Arbor, MI 2023–2026
University of Michigan, Ross School of Business Teaching Assistant — BE 562: Growth and Stabilization in the Macroeconomy	Ann Arbor, MI 2023–2025
University of Michigan, Ross School of Business Teaching Assistant — BE 688: Health Policy & Politics Residential in DC	Ann Arbor, MI 2023, 2025
U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Instructor — Data Analysis and Visualization in Excel	Washington, DC 2020
University of California, Department of Political Economy Teaching Assistant — IAS 107: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory	Berkeley, CA 2016–2018
University of California, Department of Political Economy Teaching Assistant — IAS 106: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory	Berkeley, CA 2016–2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Institute for Healthcare Policy & Innovation Doctoral Researcher	Ann Arbor, MI 2023–2025
• Head researcher, coder, and modeler for NIH R01 grant: “The Affordable Care Act’s Role in Aging Disparities Before and After Medicare” • Utilized American Communities Survey, Health and Retirement Survey, and Current Population Survey to construct interrupted time series and event-study triple-difference models; estimated causal effects of the ACA on health equity and coverage for the 50–64 aged population • Head researcher for grant examining effects of Medicare’s rural floor wage index policy and switching between Medicare Advantage and traditional Medicare on persons with dementia	
Agency for Healthcare Research & Quality Research Intern	Woodlawn, MD 2023
• Conducted research for the Center for Financing, Access, and Cost Trends using the Medical Expenditure Panel Survey and National Health Interview Survey to examine differences in health status and health risk between Medicaid and Marketplace enrollees	
UC Berkeley Goldman School of Public Policy Research & Policy Consultant	Berkeley, CA 2017–2018
• “CA County Spending Effects: Behavioral Health & Reducing Recidivism”: Original research	

- for the California Behavioral Health Directors' Association; analyzed spending allocation effects on behavioral health outcomes, recidivism, and downstream costs
- “An Analysis of Community Outreach Methods and Their Effectiveness on CalEITC Claiming”: Original research for the California Department of Community Services & Development; used county-reported data and regressions to determine most effective outreach methods for the California Earned Income Tax Credit

UC Berkeley Labor Center
Graduate Student Researcher

Berkeley, CA
2017

- Original research; head analyst & modeler for center publication on effects of Republican ACA repeal-and-replace healthcare proposals
- Prepared Medi-Cal data and literature reviews for the California Legislature and public stakeholders

University of California, San Francisco — Institute for Health Policy Studies San Francisco, CA
Research Assistant 2017

- Provided research assistance for A. Gaffney paper “The Effect of Large-scale Health Coverage Expansions in Wealthy Nations on Society-Wide Healthcare Utilization” and JG Kahn paper “Lowering prescription drug costs in the US: Why prices are high and potential policy interventions”
- Led research constructing a model projecting the effect of a US transition to single-payer on household spending

Cal Poly San Luis Obispo, Economics Department
Capstone Researcher

San Luis Obispo, CA
2012–2013

- “Lessons for the Affordable Care Act: Finding Difference-in-Differences from the Massachusetts Health Reform”: Original research using DiD methodology with Massachusetts health reform to project effects of the ACA on health spending per capita, copays, and ER utilization

RELATED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

California Health Benefits Review Program
Cost Lead

Remote
2026–Present

- Serve as Medicaid and CA health policy subject matter expert for FY 2026 legislative year; analyze the financial impact of proposed health insurance legislation for the California Legislature using a cost model to provide independent, data-driven cost estimates

North Carolina Dept. of Health and Human Services
Senior Policy Advisor

Remote
2025–Present

- Advise Medicaid executive team including Chief Actuary and Medicaid Director on H.R. 1 (OBBBA) implementation, provider taxes, state directed payments, 1115 waivers, regulatory effect support, and impact modeling/evaluation

17a
Consultant

Remote
2024–Present

- Assisted in development and implementation of a major state's \$8 billion Medicaid 1115 waiver amendment
- Developed strategies for state implementation of screening, enrollment, delivery, and tracking of Health-Related Social Needs (HRSN) services, and policy analysis for transition to a total cost-of-care model (AHEAD)
- Developed modeling, policy response, and briefing material for financial implications of proposed Community Engagement requirements on providers
- Advised on reformation of a large state's pharmacy benefit for Medicaid, including pooling with other state public agencies, interstate Medicaid pools, and implementation of novel rebate negotiating methods, a uniform preferred drug list, and formulary construction; generated \$200M+ in annual savings

Center for Medicare and Medicaid Services
PhD Intern

Woodlawn, MD
2023

- Subject matter expert on Medicaid financing; drafted Medicaid 1115 waiver demonstration amendment Special Terms and Conditions and evaluation designs for New York, California, and Massachusetts, totaling more than \$10 billion in federal funds
- Drafted new substance use disorder and mental health disorder monitoring guidelines for states

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office of the Secretary
Medicaid Policy & Budget Analyst — Assistant Secretary for Financial Resources

Washington, DC
2019–2021

- Headed the Medicaid financing portfolio, coordinating HHS analysis on Medicaid managed care, telehealth, DSH, state financing, territories & tribal financing, 1115 waivers, drug pricing and rebates, Medicaid apportionment, and baseline
- Personally wrote waiver updates, analysis, and tracking for HHS Secretary's daily briefing book
- Coordinated the budget process from policy formulation at CMS to OMB/White House submission, including congressional justifications
- Represented the Assistant Secretary and Office of Budget for all comments/revisions to Medicaid proposed and final regulations, 1115 waiver applications, CMMI models, budget scoring, draft legislation, and all guidance including State Medicaid Director Letters

Center for Medicare and Medicaid Innovation
Economist

Woodlawn, MD
2019

- Designed, conducted, and performed studies on economic issues related to CMMI models (Oncology Care Model, Comprehensive Care for Joint Replacement Model, Medicaid Maternal Mortality Model, Bundled Payments)
- Personally wrote the initial Innovation Center Investment Proposal (ICIP) for the Transforming Maternal Health (TMaH) model
- Designated by leadership as the “bridge” between executive policy and research/evaluation teams; distilled academic research into actionable insights
- Analyzed claims, Part D, and expenditure data from major CMS data warehouses to inform policy decisions and model development

California Association of Public Hospitals & Health Systems
Senior Policy & Finance Analyst

Oakland, CA
2018–2019

- Developed policy, financial, and operational initiatives for all 22 of California's public safety

net systems; executed legislative initiatives and built relationships with California state leadership and health executives

- Led “big data” team: encounter data & Medicaid/Medicare cost report analysis, regulatory analysis of Medicare and Medicaid payment policy, 340B drug policy, research of Medicaid incentive payment and value-based models (APMs)

Office of Assemblymember David Chiu, 17th District
Consultant for the Select Committee on Health Reform

Sacramento, CA
2017

- Advised Asm. Chiu on policy matters; drafted and advanced a package of 13 reform bills including drug pricing
- Led meetings with legislators and stakeholders; presented original material to advance health reform

Kaiser Permanente
Master’s Intern, Health Policy

Oakland, CA
2017

- Served under the Government Relations team at Kaiser Permanente’s program offices, assisting in advocacy for commercial and Medicare cost controls, fair Medicare Advantage regulations, and Medicare Advantage reimbursement
- Stretch Project: “Emerging Health Risk Trends for the Millennial Generation and Gen X”

California Department of Health Care Services
Health Program Specialist — Office of the Director

Sacramento, CA
2013–2016

- Sole direct report to the California Medicaid Director and her Deputy Director team; managed and coordinated multiple high-priority projects across competing deadlines
- Led discussions with CA Legislature, CMS leadership, CFOs of county hospital systems, county executives, and consulting entities
- Led policy and financial analysis of California’s 1115 Waiver; personally developed and oversaw budget neutrality calculations
- Crafted data analyses and position papers for legislative/CMS negotiations on the MCO tax, Hep C drug spending, and coverage expansion
- Lead coordinator for the Department’s 32 divisions on CMS’ 2017 Medicaid Managed Care Mega-regulation, drug inflation rebate legislation, FQHC payment reform pilot, and capitated rate and delivery system incentive payment innovation

REFERENCES

Andrew M. Ryan, Ph.D.
Dept. of Health Services, Policy, & Practice
Brown University
andrew_m_ryan@brown.edu

Richard Hirth, Ph.D.
Dept. of Health Policy & Management
University of Michigan
rhirth@umich.edu

Renuka Tipirneni, M.D., M.Sc.
Institute for Healthcare Policy and Innovation
University of Michigan
rtipirne@umich.edu

Sarah Miller, Ph.D.
Ross School of Business
University of Michigan
mille@umich.edu

Tom Buchmueller, Ph.D.
Ross School of Business
University of Michigan
tbuch@umich.edu